MONTHLY UPDATE

Mauritania: monthly update, September – October 2026

Edition of 2026-10-16-2 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

Developments reported in sources published between the beginning of last month and today, grouped by story, oldest first.

STATUS · PROGRESS · INSTITUTION HOSTING

GOVERNANCE
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ICT INFRASTRUCTURE
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DPI
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TECHNOLOGY
AI · Innovation ecosystem

CAPACITY
Training and skills

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

NATIONAL DIGITAL PAYMENT STRATEGY 2023-2028

- **Stratégie Nationale de Paiement Numérique (SNPN)** — Banque Centrale de Mauritanie, 6 September 2026

  Mauritania's central bank publishes its National Digital Payment Strategy on its fintech portal, presented as a natural extension of the national financial inclusion strategy and aimed at widening access to financial services for rural and under-banked citizens. It sets five objectives: easing the regulation of payment and electronic-money institutions to attract fintech investment, rebuilding the digital payments infrastructure, modernising financial services around innovation, building adoption and use, and putting a governance system in place across the whole financial-digital sector. No implementation report or measured outturn against any of them appears on the page.

NATIONAL FRAMEWORK RESTRICTING MINORS' ACCESS TO SOCIAL MEDIA

- **مجلس الوزراء يصادق على بيانين حول الحماية من مضار الفضاء الرقمي وتنظيم منتدى الجاليات الموريتانية في الخارج** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 16 September 2026

Mauritania's Council of Ministers took a statement on 16 September 2026 proposing a national framework on minors' use of social media, with an access threshold at 16. It would switch off recommendation algorithms, infinite scroll and autoplay for minors by default, ban advertising aimed at them and add a reporting route for children harmed online; no draft text has been published.

- **وزير تمكين الشباب: نعمل على اتخاذ إجراءات جديدة لحماية القاصرين من مخاطر منصات التواصل الاجتماعي** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 16 September 2026

  Mauritania's youth minister said the government is preparing legal and technical measures to protect minors on social media. The Council of Ministers approved an interministerial committee, including the population registry agency and the data protection authority, to propose a framework law with technical mechanisms to limit children's access to harmful platforms. A draft law banning online gambling is also being prepared.

Standards

TECHNICAL ASSISTANCE ON PUBLIC FINANCE STATISTICS AND STATE-ENTERPRISE DEBT

- **Le ministre des Finances recoit une mission d'assistance technique du FMI** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 3 September 2026

  Mauritania's finance minister, Codioro Moussa N'Guénore, received an IMF technical assistance mission from AFRITAC West in Nouakchott. The mission works on compiling public finance statistics and public enterprise debt in line with the IMF's 2014 Government Finance Statistics Manual, including the collection and consolidation of state enterprises' financial data.

NATIONAL FRAMEWORK FOR PUBLIC DIGITAL SERVICE STANDARDS

- **إطلاق برنامج تكويني لتوحيد معايير البنية الرقمية للدولة** — الإعلام نت (Elilam), 28 September 2026

  Mauritania's digital ministry opened a week-long training for its officials and 120 new staff on applying unified state digital-infrastructure standards to every new digital service, following a March consultation of 34 ministerial sectors under the Digital-Y project. The ministry says the national government cloud now hosts state services and its design system is in use internally ahead of wider rollout.

Finance

New investments

WARDIP DIGITAL TRANSFORMATION PROGRAMME

- **World Bank — WARDIP SOP1 additional financing, Mauritania, 2026** — Future Afrique (AMI communique), 16 September 2026

  The World Bank's International Development Association signed a EUR 25.8 million loan with Mauritania on 16 September 2026 as additional financing for the first phase of the West Africa Regional Digital Integration Programme (WARDIP). The money is for broadband infrastructure, online services and electronic payments.

- **Conseil des Ministres : le Président de la République enjoint d'accélérer les composantes du programme du gouvernement** — Future Afrique, 14 October 2026

  Mauritania's Council of Ministers on 14 October 2026 adopted bills to ratify World Bank IDA financing agreements, including a EUR 25.8m additional loan for the WARDIP regional digital programme covering broadband, e-services and e-payments. Another agreement, a EUR 19.7m credit and SDR 5.6m grant signed on 21 August, supports the social registry and the Takaful safety-net programme.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SATELLITE BROADBAND LICENSING

- **أنترنت ستارلينك يطرق أبواب موريتانيا** — MauriNews (موريتيوز), 15 September 2026

  Mauritania appears on a satellite operator's list of sixteen African markets targeted for launch during 2026, after roughly two years seeking a licence. The authorities' conditions concern security guarantees and control over data, and an application lodged with a local partner is still pending.

MOBILE SERVICE QUALITY AGAINST LICENCE OBLIGATIONS

- **Contrôle de la qualité de service des opérateurs de communications électroniques : MATTEL sa, MAURITEL sa et CHINGUITEL sa — Période : du 13 février au 22 mars 2026** — Autorité de Régulation (ARE), Mauritanie — Direction Technique Télécoms et Poste, 7 October 2026

  Mauritania's regulator ARE published on 7 October 2026 its re-inspection of mobile service quality carried out from 13 February to 22 March 2026, finding that Mattel, Mauritel and Chinguitel still breach their licence obligations. Voice service failed in several towns and on major roads (Chinguitel on nine routes, Mattel on six), and mobile data fell below 3G thresholds in 14 localities for Mauritel and 12 for Chinguitel.

- **Mauritania's Digital Economy Plans Face Persistent Telecom Network Quality Problems** — Ecofin Agency, 9 October 2026

  Mauritania's regulator ARE released results on 7 October 2026 of a February–March inspection that found failings in voice and mobile data services at Mattel, Mauritel and Chinguitel, including call completion and drop rates in several towns and on main roads and weak 3G and 4G performance. Ecofin sets this against the government's plans for online public services, AI and e-commerce.

Cybersecurity

INTERNET RESILIENCE SCORE

- **Mauritania — Internet Society Pulse country report** — Internet Society Pulse, 16 September 2026

  The Internet Society rates Mauritania's internet resilience at 43%, with 3% of the 1,000 most-visited websites served from local servers or caches against a 50% target. About 46% of the population uses the internet.

NATIONAL COMPUTER EMERGENCY RESPONSE TEAM

- **Avis d'Appel d'Offres National : mise en place du CSIRT national et du SOC RIAD** — Ministere de la Transformation Numerique et de la Modernisation de l'Administration (WARDIP PMU), 9 October 2026

  Mauritania's WARDIP project unit at the digital transformation ministry issued a national tender on 9 October 2026 to set up a national CSIRT and a security operations centre for RIAD, the government's high-speed intranet, paid from World Bank credit IDA-7445-MR. Bids are due on 17 November 2026 with a 950,000 MRU bid guarantee. No contract value is stated.

DPI

Data Exchange

CONSTRUCTION FIRM QUALIFICATION AND CLASSIFICATION PLATFORM

- **وزيرة الإسكان: رقمنة تأهيل وتصنيف المؤسسات تعزز الشفافية وتحد من الغش** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 16 September 2026

Mauritania's housing minister, Naha mint Hamdi ould Mouknass, said on 16 September 2026 that qualification and classification of construction firms now runs only through a government platform linked to tax, transport, procurement, social security and company registry databases, to reduce fraud. She was presenting a draft decree that would replace Decree 172-2022 and cut the classification commission from 22 members to 15.

Digital Payments and Fintech

MOBILE BANKING AND PAYMENTS SERVICE

- بنكيلي.. التطبيق الذي صنع الدفع الرقمي في موريتانيا — Le Quotidien de Nouakchott, 8 September 2026

  A commentary in Le Quotidien de Nouakchott defends Bankily, the mobile banking app Banque Populaire de Mauritanie launched in 2020, after complaints about a faulty update that was temporarily rolled back. Citing the central bank's 2025 annual report, it says Bankily handles about 1.1 million transactions a day, nearly 80% of bank-wallet transactions by number and 73.5% by value.

NATIONAL INSTANT PAYMENT SYSTEM FOR FINANCIAL-SERVICES INTEROPERABILITY

- **Implementation of an instant payment system in Mauritania enabling the interoperability of financial services** — Mauritania Tenders, 16 September 2026

  Mauritania sought providers for an instant payment system to make financial services interoperable, under the World Bank-financed regional digital integration programme. The call closed on 3 June 2025.

TRADE FACILITATION COMMITMENT ON ELECTRONIC PAYMENT OF DUTIES

- **Mauritanie — 7.2 Paiement par voie électronique (Base de données de l'Accord sur la facilitation des échanges)** — World Trade Organization, 16 September 2026

  Mauritania's commitment under the WTO trade facilitation agreement to allow electronic payment of border duties was due by 31 December 2024; it has asked for 31 December 2027, saying it still needs a partner to help, and the request is not yet approved. The work includes linking the customs system, the Treasury and banks.

CENTRAL BANK DIGITAL CURRENCY (MNBC) PROOF OF CONCEPT

- **BCM : réforme bancaire, fintech et monnaie numérique au cœur de la modernisation** — TRUST Magazine, 20 September 2026

  The Central Bank of Mauritania's newsletter for August 2026 reports a week of sandbox tests for its central bank digital currency proof of concept. It also reports a data platform holding over 78 million records since January 2024, two GIZ-backed fintech hackathons set for 19–22 October 2026, and a draft monetary and financial code due by mid-2027.

Registries

RURAL LAND CONCESSION REGISTRATION PLATFORM

- **Appel aux proprietaires fonciers ruraux de Nouakchott pour inscrire leurs dossiers** — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 2 September 2026

  Mauritania's technical committee on rural land and developer plots in Nouakchott called on holders of rural land concessions inside the capital's urban zone to register on the Leegoud platform by 18 September 2026. Help desks are to open in Nouakchott's three moughataas. The exercise follows a declaration to the Council of Ministers on 28 April 2026.

GEOLOCATED ADDRESSING SYSTEM

- انطلاق أعمال ورشة لعرض النظام الوطني للعنونة الرقمية والتشاور حوله — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 29 September 2026

  Mauritania's digital and land ministers opened a four-day workshop presenting the national digital addressing system for consultation. It is meant as a single reference locating plots, buildings and facilities to Universal Postal Union standards, under the World Bank-financed regional digital integration programme.

- **Mauritania Plans End-2026 Pilot of Digital Addressing System to Support E-Commerce** — Ecofin Agency, 1 October 2026

  Mauritania's Ministry of Digital Transformation presented a national digital addressing system in Nouakchott on 29 September 2026, financed by the World Bank under the WARDIP programme. It is to locate every plot and building, divide the country into postal code zones and include mapping and address management portals. A pilot is expected by the end of 2026, but no detailed timetable has been announced.

Sectoral management information systems

SIRAJ EDUCATION PLATFORM

- «انطلاق تسجيل وتحويل التلاميذ عبر منصة «سراج — تفاصيل, 28 September 2026

  Mauritania's education ministry opened pupil registration and transfers for the 2026-2027 school year on the Siraj platform on 28 September 2026. Registration and corrections run until 20 October, and the school year opens on 5 October.

Other GovTech and e-Gov

ELECTRONIC INVOICING AND TAX PLATFORM FOR PUBLIC ESTABLISHMENTS

- **Mauritanie : les établissements publics passeront à la facturation et aux paiements électroniques dès novembre - TAWASSOUL** — Tawassoul, 1 October 2026

  Mauritania's tax directorate said public establishments must use an electronic platform for invoicing, tax declarations and tax payments from 1 November 2026, reported on 1 October. No invoice may be paid unless first registered and validated on the platform. Training and technical support run through October.

SANAD UNIFIED SOCIAL ASSISTANCE PLATFORM

- تآزر تطلق منصة "سند" الرقمية لتسهيل وصول المواطنين إلى المساعدات والحقوق الاجتماعية — Le Quotidien de Nouakchott, 9 October 2026

  Mauritania's national solidarity agency launched Sanad, a single digital platform for social assistance. It opens with transport costs for 11,656 pupils and students from households in the social registry, who are verified by facial recognition.

Technology

AI

AI-BASED AGRICULTURAL AND HYDROLOGICAL EARLY WARNING SYSTEM

- تنظيم ورشة تكوينية حول نظام الإنذار المبكر الزراعي والهيدرولوجي القائم على تقنيات الذكاء الاصطناعي — Agence Mauritanienne d'Information (AMI), 8 September 2026

  Mauritania's national meteorological office ran a two-day workshop in Nouakchott from 8 September 2026 for regional administrators and its own staff on an AI-based agricultural and hydrological early warning system using the AGRIFEMIA platform. The training aims to improve forecasting of climate risks to agriculture and water resources.

Innovation ecosystem

BCM FINTECH PROGRAM

- **BCM : réforme bancaire, fintech et monnaie numérique au cœur de la modernisation** — TRUST Magazine, 20 September 2026

  Summarised under Digital Payments and Fintech.

Capacity

Training and skills

DIGITAL DOCUMENTATION TRAINING FOR EDUCATION INSPECTORS

- **وزارة التربية تنظم دورة تكوينية لتعزيز قدرات المفتشين الرقمية** — Le Quotidien de Nouakchott, 8 September 2026

  Mauritania's Ministry of Education opened a ten-day training course on 8 September 2026 for 20 secondary-school inspectors in documentation, archiving, librarianship and electronic document management. Secretary-general Sedfi Sidi Mohamed called for a modern documentation centre in the secondary inspectorate to store, classify and digitise its records.

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